



6 On a lightly floured work surface, knead the dough briefly until smooth.



7 Flour the dough and the work surface well, and roll the dough out to 6mm (¼in) thick. Using the cutter, cut out as many shapes as possible. Transfer to non-stick baking sheets.



8 Mix the offcuts of dough, re-roll, and cut out more shapes until all the dough is used. Decorate the men with raisins, giving them eyes, a nose, and buttons down the front.



9 Bake for 10–12 minutes until golden. Transfer to a wire rack to cool completely.



10 If using, mix a little icing sugar in a bowl with enough water to form a thin icing. Transfer the icing into the piping bag; placing the bag into a jug first will help.



11 Decorate the men with the piped icing to resemble clothes, hair, or whatever you prefer. Leave the icing to set completely before serving or storing.